Irish goods trade

Monthly briefing: August 2026

Data to August 2026. The latest two months are provisional and are routinely revised. Text and charts are generated automatically from Eurostat Comext data.

EXPORTS

€15.8bn

-1.3% y/y
-1.4% 3m on 3m
+6.6% 3m y/y
12-month total **€214.7bn**

IMPORTS

€12.8bn

+14.4% y/y
-3.1% 3m on 3m
+12.8% 3m y/y
12-month total **€154.0bn**

TRADE BALANCE

€3.0bn

12-month balance **€60.7bn**
-61.7bn EUR vs a year earlier

UNDERLYING EXPORTS

€7.2bn

+13.2% y/y
+29.7% 3m y/y
Excl. chemicals & pharma

US SHARE OF EXPORTS

29.2%

-13.3pp vs 12 months earlier
Share of 12-month exports

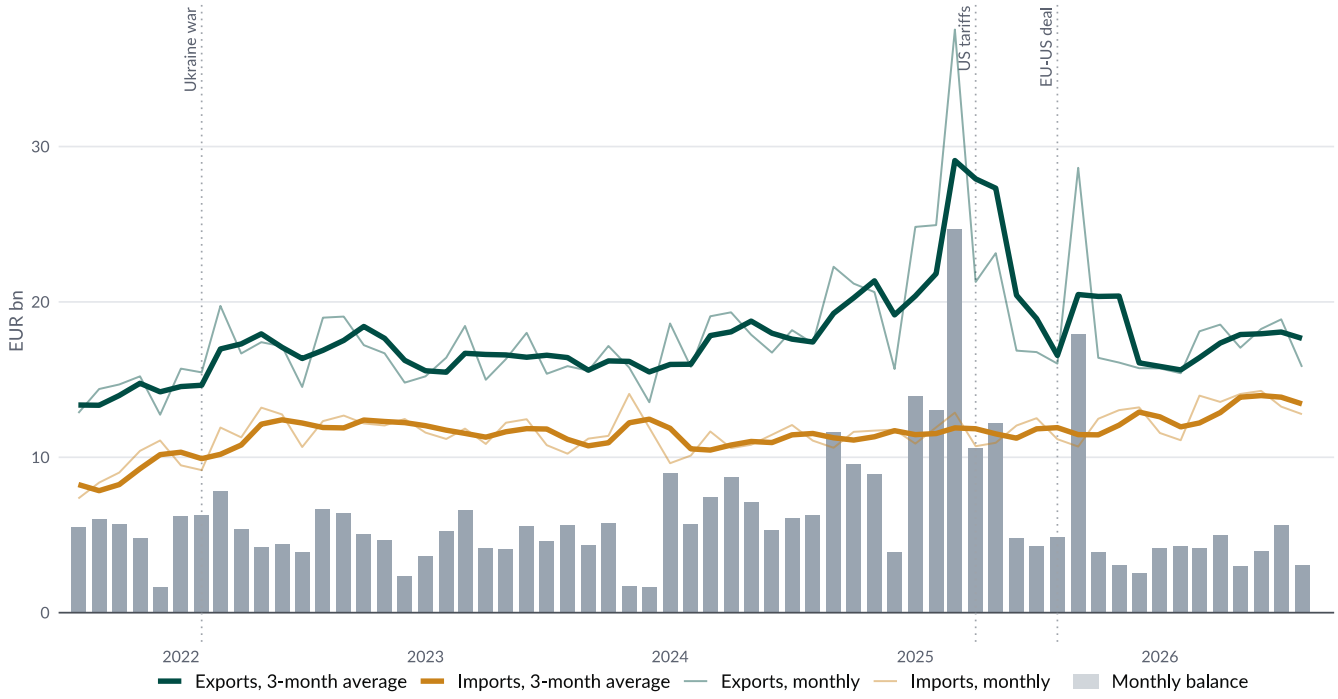
Headline figures are monthly values for August 2026, nominal EUR. y/y = on the same month a year earlier; 3m on 3m = latest three months on the previous three; 3m y/y = latest three months on the same three a year earlier. Underlying exports exclude chemicals and pharmaceuticals.

Key points

- Goods exports in August 2026 were €15.8bn, down 1.3% on a year earlier. Over the three months to August exports were up 6.6% year on year (€53.0bn). The monthly figure understates the underlying trend.
- Contributions to three-month export growth of +6.6% by product group: the largest positive contribution came from computers & electronics (+6.7pp), while organic chemicals (-3.4pp) was the largest drag.
- Excluding pharmaceuticals, three-month export growth was +15.3% year on year, and excluding all chemicals and pharmaceuticals +29.7%, compared with +6.6% for total exports. Chemicals and pharmaceuticals are weighing on the headline rate.
- Exports to the United States over the three months to August were €13.2bn, up 3.9% year on year. The US accounted for 29.2% of exports over the past 12 months, compared with 42.6% a year earlier (-13.3pp). The largest positive contribution to three-month export growth came from Rest of world (+6.3pp).
- Imports in August 2026 were €12.8bn, up 14.4% on a year earlier; over three months they were up 12.8% year on year. Excluding aircraft, three-month import growth was +21.1%.
- The 12-month rolling goods trade surplus to August was €60.7bn, €61.7bn lower than a year earlier (€122.4bn).
- At €15.8bn, exports in August 2026 were the 9th lowest of the past 36 months (median €17.6bn).

Exports and imports, last five years

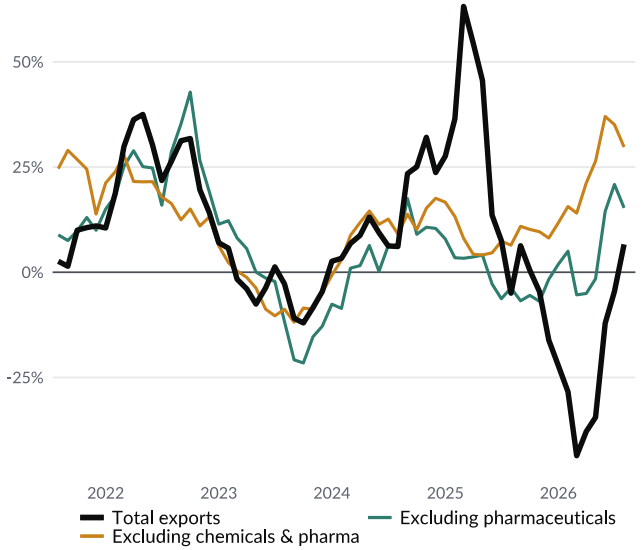
Monthly values (faint lines) and 3-month averages (bold), EUR bn; grey bars show the monthly trade balance (exports minus imports).



Exports in detail

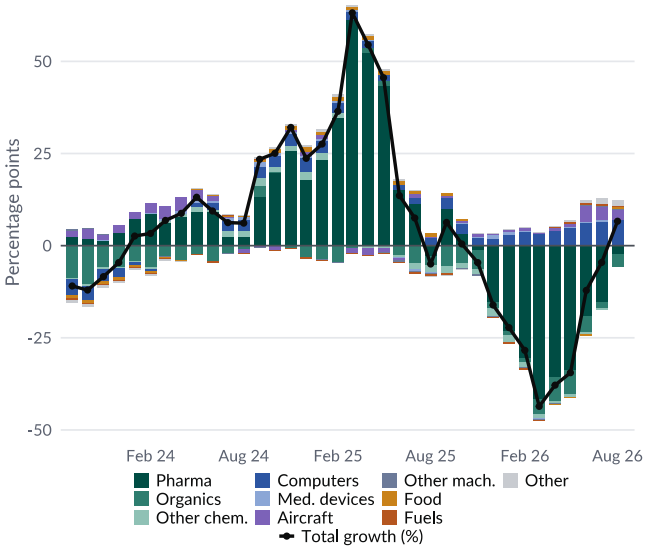
Exports: headline versus underlying growth

3-month total vs the same 3 months a year earlier, % (total, excluding pharmaceuticals and excluding chemicals & pharma).



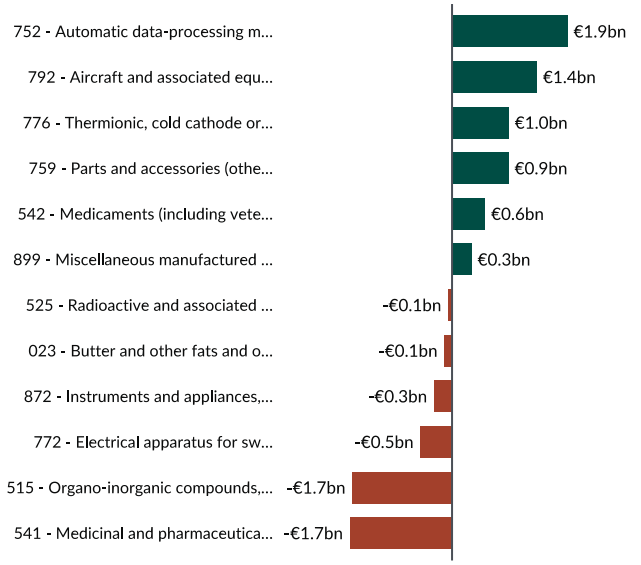
Exports: what is driving growth

Contribution of each product group to 3-month y/y exports growth, percentage points; line = total growth, %. Last 36 months.



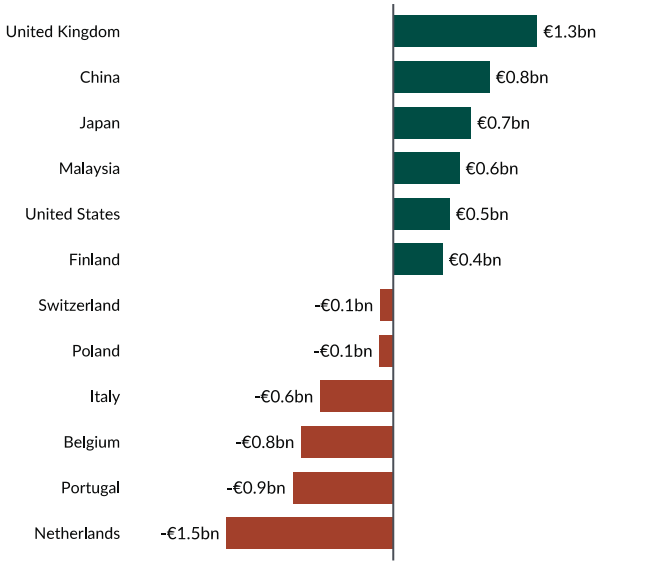
Exports: biggest product movers

Jun-Aug 2026 vs Jun-Aug 2025, EUR bn change in 3-month exports (SITC 3-digit groups)



Exports: biggest market movers

Jun-Aug 2026 vs Jun-Aug 2025, EUR bn change in 3-month exports (partner countries)



Concentration and exposure of exports

CHEMICALS & PHARMA SHARE
54.6%
-14.4pp vs 12 months earlier
-7.9pp vs 5 years earlier

TOP 3 PRODUCTS
31.7%
-16.3pp vs 12 months earlier
SITC 54163, 54293, 54154

EFFECTIVE NO. OF PRODUCTS
19.5
+8.1 vs 12 months earlier
HHI 513

EURO AREA SHARE
33.1%
+0.7pp vs 12 months earlier

GOODS BALANCE WITH THE US
€41.0bn
-49.2bn EUR vs a year earlier
12-month total

Shares are of exports over the 12 months to Aug 2026. Products are 5-digit SITC. The effective number of products is 10,000 divided by the Herfindahl-Hirschman index (HHI): exports spread evenly over that many products would be equally concentrated.